

1. Need of PL/pgSQL Block (When SQL Already Exists)

1.1 Introduction

SQL (DDL, DML, DQL) is **declarative** — it tells *what to do*.

PL/pgSQL is **procedural** — it tells *how to do it step by step*.

👉 PL/pgSQL is needed when:

- You need **conditions (IF/ELSE)**
 - You need **loops**
 - You need **variables**
 - You need **complex business logic**
-

1.2 Basic Examples (Without DML/DDL)

Example 1

```
DO $$  
  
DECLARE  
  
    v_num INT := 10;  
  
BEGIN  
  
    IF v_num > 5 THEN  
  
        RAISE NOTICE 'Greater than 5';  
  
    END IF;  
  
END $$;
```

Example 2

```
DO $$  
  
DECLARE  
  
    v_text TEXT := 'PostgreSQL';  
  
BEGIN  
  
    RAISE NOTICE 'Welcome to %', v_text;  
  
END $$;
```

1.3 Advanced Examples (With SQL + Aggregates + DML)

Example 1 (Using COUNT)

```
DO $$  
  
DECLARE  
  
    total_users INT;  
  
BEGIN  
  
    SELECT COUNT(*) INTO total_users FROM users;
```

```
IF total_users > 0 THEN

    RAISE NOTICE 'Users exist';

END IF;

END $$;

Example 2 (INSERT with condition)

DO $$

DECLARE

    v_count INT;

BEGIN

    SELECT COUNT(*) INTO v_count FROM employees;

    IF v_count = 0 THEN

        INSERT INTO employees(name) VALUES ('Admin');

    END IF;

END $$;
```

Example 3 (UPDATE with condition)

```
DO $$

BEGIN

    UPDATE employees

    SET salary = salary + 1000

    WHERE salary < 5000;

END $$;
```

2. Structure of PL/pgSQL Block (Must vs Optional)

2.1 Basic Examples

Example 1 (Minimal Block)

```
DO $$

BEGIN

    NULL;

END $$;
```

Example 2 (With Declare)

```
DO $$

DECLARE

    v_num INT := 1;

BEGIN

    RAISE NOTICE '%', v_num;
```

END \$\$;

2.2 Advanced Examples

Example 1 (Full Block with Exception)

```
DO $$  
  
DECLARE  
  
    v_result INT;  
  
BEGIN  
  
    v_result := 10 / 0;  
  
  
EXCEPTION  
  
    WHEN division_by_zero THEN  
  
        RAISE NOTICE 'Error occurred';  
  
END $$;
```

Example 2 (With SELECT INTO)

```
DO $$  
  
DECLARE  
  
    avg_salary NUMERIC;  
  
BEGIN  
  
    SELECT AVG(salary) INTO avg_salary FROM employees;  
  
    RAISE NOTICE 'Average: %', avg_salary;  
  
END $$;
```

Example 3 (Nested Block)

```
DO $$  
  
BEGIN  
  
    DECLARE v_inner INT := 5;  
  
    BEGIN  
  
        RAISE NOTICE '%', v_inner;  
  
    END;  
  
END $$;
```

3. Block Processing (DO, DECLARE, BEGIN...END)

3.1 Basic Examples

Example 1

```
DO $$  
  
BEGIN
```

```
    RAISE NOTICE 'Hello World';

END $$;
```

Example 2

```
DO $$

DECLARE

    v_counter INT := 1;

BEGIN

    RAISE NOTICE 'Counter: %', v_counter;

END $$;
```

3.2 Advanced Examples

Example 1 (Using SUM)

```
DO $$

DECLARE

    total_salary NUMERIC;

BEGIN

    SELECT SUM(salary) INTO total_salary FROM employees;

    RAISE NOTICE '%', total_salary;

END $$;
```

Example 2 (DELETE with condition)

```
DO $$

BEGIN

    DELETE FROM employees WHERE salary < 3000;

END $$;
```

Example 3 (Insert + Aggregate)

```
DO $$

DECLARE

    max_salary NUMERIC;

BEGIN

    SELECT MAX(salary) INTO max_salary FROM employees;


    INSERT INTO audit_log(message)

    VALUES ('Max salary is ' || max_salary);

END $$;
```

4. Conditional Logic (IF, ELSE, ELSIF, CASE)

4.1 Basic Examples

Example 1 (IF)

```
DO $$  
  
DECLARE v_num INT := 20;  
  
BEGIN  
  
    IF v_num > 10 THEN  
  
        RAISE NOTICE 'Big';  
  
    END IF;  
  
END $$;
```

Example 2 (CASE)

```
DO $$  
  
DECLARE v_score INT := 70;  
  
BEGIN  
  
    RAISE NOTICE '%',  
  
    CASE  
  
        WHEN v_score >= 50 THEN 'Pass'  
  
        ELSE 'Fail'  
  
    END;  
  
END $$;
```

4.2 Advanced Examples

Example 1 (CASE in SELECT)

```
SELECT name,  
  
CASE  
  
    WHEN salary > 5000 THEN 'High'  
  
    ELSE 'Low'  
  
END  
  
FROM employees;
```

Example 2 (IF with COUNT)

```
DO $$  
  
DECLARE total INT;  
  
BEGIN  
  
    SELECT COUNT(*) INTO total FROM employees;  
  
  
  
    IF total > 10 THEN  
  
        RAISE NOTICE 'Large company';  
  
    END IF;
```

END \$\$;

Example 3 (UPDATE with CASE)

UPDATE employees

SET bonus =

CASE

 WHEN salary > 5000 THEN 1000

 ELSE 500

END;

5. Loops (LOOP, WHILE, FOR)

5.1 Basic Examples

Example 1 (LOOP)

DO \$\$

DECLARE i INT := 1;

BEGIN

 LOOP

 EXIT WHEN i > 3;

 RAISE NOTICE '%', i;

 i := i + 1;

 END LOOP;

END \$\$;

Example 2 (FOR)

DO \$\$

BEGIN

 FOR i IN 1..3 LOOP

 RAISE NOTICE '%', i;

 END LOOP;

END \$\$;

5.2 Advanced Examples

Example 1 (FOR with SELECT)

DO \$\$

DECLARE rec RECORD;

BEGIN

 FOR rec IN SELECT name FROM employees LOOP

 RAISE NOTICE '%', rec.name;

```
        END LOOP;

END $$;

Example 2 (WHILE + UPDATE)

DO $$

DECLARE v_id INT := 1;

BEGIN

    WHILE v_id <= 5 LOOP

        UPDATE employees SET salary = salary + 100 WHERE id = v_id;

        v_id := v_id + 1;

    END LOOP;

END $$;
```

```
Example 3 (Aggregate inside loop)

DO $$

DECLARE total NUMERIC := 0;

rec RECORD;

BEGIN

    FOR rec IN SELECT salary FROM employees LOOP

        total := total + rec.salary;

    END LOOP;

    RAISE NOTICE 'Total: %', total;

END $$;
```

6. Core and Advanced SQL in PostgreSQL

6.1 Basic Examples

```
Example 1

SELECT 10 + 5;

Example 2

SELECT CURRENT_DATE;
```

6.2 Advanced Examples

```
Example 1 (Aggregate Functions)

SELECT AVG(salary), MAX(salary), MIN(salary)

FROM employees;

Example 2 (GROUP BY)

SELECT department_id, COUNT(*)
```

FROM employees

GROUP BY department_id;

Example 3 (JOIN)

SELECT e.name, d.department_name

FROM employees e

JOIN departments d

ON e.department_id = d.id;

Example 4 (Subquery)

SELECT name

FROM employees

WHERE salary > (SELECT AVG(salary) FROM employees);

7. Conclusion

- SQL handles **data operations**
- PL/pgSQL handles **logic and control flow**
- Both together create **powerful database applications**

8. Final Summary

- Use SQL → for querying and data manipulation
 - Use PL/pgSQL → for logic, automation, and control
 - Use both → for real-world applications
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PL/pgSQL Report: Difference Between IF and WHEN in PostgreSQL

1. Introduction

PostgreSQL provides two main ways to implement conditional logic:

- IF statement (procedural logic)
- WHEN clause (used inside SQL/PLpgSQL structures)

Although they appear similar, they serve **different purposes** and are **not interchangeable**.

2. Overview of IF Statement

Definition

IF is a **control flow statement** used in PL/pgSQL to execute code conditionally.

Syntax

IF condition THEN

statements;

ELSIF condition THEN

statements;

ELSE

statements;

END IF;

Example

DO \$\$

DECLARE

v_num INT := 10;

BEGIN

IF v_num > 5 THEN

RAISE NOTICE 'Greater than 5';

ELSE

RAISE NOTICE 'Less or equal to 5';

END IF;

END \$\$;

Key Characteristics

- Used in **procedural blocks**
 - Can execute **multiple statements**
 - Supports complex logic
 - Cannot be used in SQL queries
-

3. Overview of WHEN Clause

Definition

WHEN is a **conditional clause** used inside predefined SQL or PL/pgSQL structures.

Where WHEN is Used

- 1. CASE statements
- 2. EXCEPTION handling
- 3. TRIGGER conditions

4. WHEN in Different Structures

4.1 CASE Structure

```
SELECT  
  
CASE  
  
    WHEN age >= 18 THEN 'Adult'  
  
    ELSE 'Minor'  
  
END  
  
FROM users;
```

👉 Returns a value based on conditions.

4.2 EXCEPTION Handling

```
DO $$  
  
BEGIN  
  
    1 / 0;  
  
EXCEPTION  
  
    WHEN division_by_zero THEN  
  
        RAISE NOTICE 'Cannot divide by zero';  
  
END $$;
```

👉 Handles specific runtime errors.

4.3 Trigger Condition

```
CREATE TRIGGER check_age  
  
BEFORE INSERT ON users  
  
FOR EACH ROW  
  
WHEN (NEW.age > 18)  
  
EXECUTE FUNCTION validate_user();
```

👉 Filters when a trigger should execute.

5. Key Differences Between IF and WHEN

Feature	IF	WHEN
Type	Statement	Clause
Usage	Procedural logic Inside structures	
Standalone	Yes	No
Executes multiple statements	Yes	No
Used in SQL queries	No	Yes
Returns value	No	Yes (via CASE)

6. Can IF Be Used Instead of WHEN?

 No (in SQL queries)

SELECT IF salary > 5000 THEN 'High'; -- INVALID

 Correct Approach

```
SELECT
CASE
    WHEN salary > 5000 THEN 'High'
END
FROM employees;
```

7. Limitations of IF

- Cannot be used in:
 - SELECT statements
 - WHERE, GROUP BY, ORDER BY
 - Only works inside:
 - Functions
 - Procedures
 - DO blocks
 - Cannot directly return values in SQL queries
-

8. Limitations of WHEN

- Cannot be used independently
- Cannot execute multiple statements
- Only works inside structures like:
 - CASE
 - EXCEPTION
 - TRIGGER
- Designed for **value-based logic**, not procedural control

9. Practical Comparison

Using CASE (WHEN)

```
SELECT
    CASE
        WHEN salary > 5000 THEN 'High'
        ELSE 'Low'
    END
FROM employees;
```

Using IF

```
DO $$
DECLARE
    v_salary INT := 6000;
BEGIN
    IF v_salary > 5000 THEN
        RAISE NOTICE 'High';
    ELSE
        RAISE NOTICE 'Low';
    END IF;
END $$;
```

10. Conceptual Difference

- IF → Controls **execution flow**
- WHEN → Defines **conditions within expressions/structures**

11. Internal Working (Important Concept)

PostgreSQL has two engines:

SQL Engine

- Handles queries
- Uses CASE and WHEN

PL/pgSQL Engine

- Handles procedural code
- Uses IF, loops, variables

12. Conclusion

- IF is used for **procedural decision-making**
- WHEN is used for **conditional expressions within structures**

- They serve different purposes and cannot replace each other
-

13. One-Line Summary

IF is a procedural control statement used in PL/pgSQL blocks, whereas WHEN is a conditional clause used inside SQL structures like CASE, EXCEPTION, and triggers.

1. Introduction

The **DVD Rental database** is a widely used PostgreSQL sample database that simulates a real-world rental system. It contains tables such as:

- customer
- film
- rental
- payment
- inventory
- category

This report demonstrates **advanced PL/pgSQL block usage** using:

- DML (INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE)
 - DDL (CREATE, ALTER)
 - Conditional logic (IF, CASE)
 - Loops (FOR, WHILE, LOOP)
 - Aggregates (COUNT, SUM, AVG)
-

2. Scenario 1: Conditional Insert Based on Customer Activity

Objective

Insert customers into a loyal_customers table if they have more than 30 rentals.

DDL Setup

```
CREATE TABLE loyal_customers (  
    customer_id INT,  
    total_rentals INT  
);
```

PL/pgSQL Block

```
DO $$  
  
DECLARE  
    rec RECORD;  
    rental_count INT;  
  
BEGIN  
  
    FOR rec IN SELECT customer_id FROM customer LOOP  
  
        SELECT COUNT(*) INTO rental_count  
  
        FROM rental
```

```
WHERE customer_id = rec.customer_id;
```

```
IF rental_count > 30 THEN
```

```
    INSERT INTO loyal_customers
```

```
    VALUES (rec.customer_id, rental_count);
```

```
END IF;
```

```
END LOOP;
```

```
END $$;
```

3. Scenario 2: Conditional Update Using CASE

Objective

Update film rental rates based on film length.

```
DO $$
```

```
BEGIN
```

```
    UPDATE film
```

```
    SET rental_rate =
```

```
    CASE
```

```
        WHEN length > 120 THEN rental_rate + 2
```

```
        WHEN length > 90 THEN rental_rate + 1
```

```
        ELSE rental_rate
```

```
    END;
```

```
END $$;
```

4. Scenario 3: Loop Through Rentals and Calculate Revenue

Objective

Calculate total revenue per customer using loop.

```
DO $$
```

```
DECLARE
```

```
    rec RECORD;
```

```
    total_payment NUMERIC;
```

```
BEGIN
```

```
    FOR rec IN SELECT customer_id FROM customer LOOP
```

```
        SELECT SUM(amount) INTO total_payment
```

```
FROM payment

WHERE customer_id = rec.customer_id;


RAISE NOTICE 'Customer % → Total Payment: %',
rec.customer_id, total_payment;


END LOOP;

END $$;
```

5. Scenario 4: Conditional Deletion Based on Inactivity

Objective

Delete customers who have no rentals.

```
DO $$

DECLARE

    rec RECORD;

    rental_count INT;

BEGIN

    FOR rec IN SELECT customer_id FROM customer LOOP

        SELECT COUNT(*) INTO rental_count

        FROM rental

        WHERE customer_id = rec.customer_id;

        IF rental_count = 0 THEN

            DELETE FROM customer WHERE customer_id = rec.customer_id;

        END IF;

    END LOOP;

END $$;
```

6. Scenario 5: Dynamic Table Creation (DDL in PL/pgSQL)

Objective

Create a summary table dynamically.

```
DO $$

BEGIN
```



```
EXECUTE '  
  
CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS customer_summary (  
  
    customer_id INT,  
  
    total_rentals INT,  
  
    total_payment NUMERIC  
  
    )';  
  
END $$;
```

7. Scenario 6: Populate Summary Table Using Loop + Aggregates

```
DO $$  
  
DECLARE  
  
    rec RECORD;  
  
    total_rentals INT;  
  
    total_payment NUMERIC;  
  
BEGIN  
  
    FOR rec IN SELECT customer_id FROM customer LOOP  
  
  
        SELECT COUNT(*) INTO total_rentals  
  
        FROM rental  
  
        WHERE customer_id = rec.customer_id;  
  
  
        SELECT SUM(amount) INTO total_payment  
  
        FROM payment  
  
        WHERE customer_id = rec.customer_id;  
  
  
        INSERT INTO customer_summary  
  
        VALUES (rec.customer_id, total_rentals, total_payment);  
  
  
    END LOOP;  
  
END $$;
```

8. Scenario 7: WHILE Loop for Batch Processing

Objective

Increase rental rate for first 10 films.

```
DO $$
```

```
DECLARE

    counter INT := 1;

BEGIN

    WHILE counter <= 10 LOOP

        UPDATE film

        SET rental_rate = rental_rate + 0.5

        WHERE film_id = counter;

        counter := counter + 1;

    END LOOP;

END $$;
```

9. Scenario 8: Exception Handling with Logging

Objective

Handle errors during updates.

```
DO $$

BEGIN

    UPDATE film SET rental_rate = rental_rate / 0;

EXCEPTION

    WHEN division_by_zero THEN

        RAISE NOTICE 'Error: Division by zero occurred';

END $$;
```

10. Scenario 9: Conditional Logic with Multiple Criteria

Objective

Categorize customers based on spending.

```
DO $$

DECLARE

    rec RECORD;

    total NUMERIC;

    category TEXT;

BEGIN

    FOR rec IN SELECT customer_id FROM customer LOOP
```

```
SELECT SUM(amount) INTO total
FROM payment
WHERE customer_id = rec.customer_id;

category :=
CASE
    WHEN total > 200 THEN 'Premium'
    WHEN total > 100 THEN 'Gold'
    ELSE 'Regular'
END;

RAISE NOTICE 'Customer % → %',
rec.customer_id, category;

END LOOP;

END $$;
```

11. Scenario 10: Nested Blocks and Advanced Logic

```
DO $$
DECLARE
    rec RECORD;
BEGIN
    FOR rec IN SELECT film_id, rental_rate FROM film LOOP

        BEGIN
            IF rec.rental_rate < 1 THEN
                UPDATE film
                SET rental_rate = rental_rate + 1
                WHERE film_id = rec.film_id;
            END IF;

        EXCEPTION
            WHEN OTHERS THEN
                RAISE NOTICE 'Error updating film %', rec.film_id;
        END;
    END LOOP;
END;
```

```
END LOOP;  
  
END $$;
```

12. Key Concepts Demonstrated

Concept	Used In
FOR LOOP	Iterating customers/films
WHILE LOOP	Batch updates
IF / CASE	Conditional logic
DML	INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE
DDL	CREATE TABLE
Aggregates	COUNT, SUM
Exception Handling	Error management
Dynamic SQL	EXECUTE

13. Conclusion

- This report demonstrates that PL/pgSQL:
- Enables **automation of complex workflows**
 - Combines **SQL power with programming logic**
 - Supports **real-world business scenarios**

Using the DVD Rental database, we implemented:

- Conditional insertions
- Loop-based processing
- Dynamic table creation
- Advanced decision-making logic

14. Final Insight

PL/pgSQL transforms PostgreSQL from a query engine into a full-fledged programming environment capable of handling enterprise-level logic directly inside the database.